Year	Schemes (No.)	Beneficiaries (No. in Crore)	DBT (in Cash), ₹ in Crore	DBT (in Kind), ₹ in Crore	DBT Total, ₹ in Crore
2013-14	28	10.8	7,367.7	-	7,367.7
2014-15	34	22.8	38, 926.2	-	38, 926.2
2015-16	59	31.2	61, 942.4	-	61, 942.2
2016-17	142	35.7	74, 689.4	-	74, 689.4
2017-18	437	77.7	1, 70, 292.2	20, 578.7	1, 90, 870.9
2018-19	434	76.3	2,14,092	1,15, 704.3	3, 29, 796.3

Source: Collated from Minister of State for Finance Anurag Singh Thakur, Answer to Lok Sabha Unstarred Question No. 1183, 19 September 2020; Minister of State for Finance P. Radhakrishnan, Answer to Lok Sabha Unstarred Question No. 2827, 28 December 2018; Cash and kind break-up of total 2017-18 and 2018-19 transfers is from DBT Mission, Government of India, https://dbtbharat.gov.in/[11]

That these direct cash transfers for a wide range of schemes—LPG, rural housing, toilets—became the basis for a new kind of political mobilisation for Modi and the BJP has long been clear. (Chapter 10 details how they became a vital part of the government's economic policy, and a crucial part of the BJP's arsenal in combating the economic and political costs of the coronavirus lockdown in 2020.) The journalist Pravin Kumar remembers travelling through a village, Harchandpur, near Raebareli, in March 2019, just before the Lok Sabha election. While driving through, he noticed a festive atmosphere, almost like a village fair, with a lot of people out on the road. He remembers stopping and asking residents if they were celebrating a festival. They told him they had just received the first instalment of ₹2,000 in a DBT into their accounts under the PM-Kisan Scheme. Two such instalments (of a total of three annual payments) were made to 4.74 crore registered farmers in February and March 2019, just before the elections, with the ECI's consent. The scheme itself was formally launched by Modi on 24 February 2019 in Gorakhpur, the UP chief minister's constituency, by transferring the first instalment to 1.01 crore farmers, amounting to ₹2,021 crore.[12] On the campaign trail in UP that year, the prime